

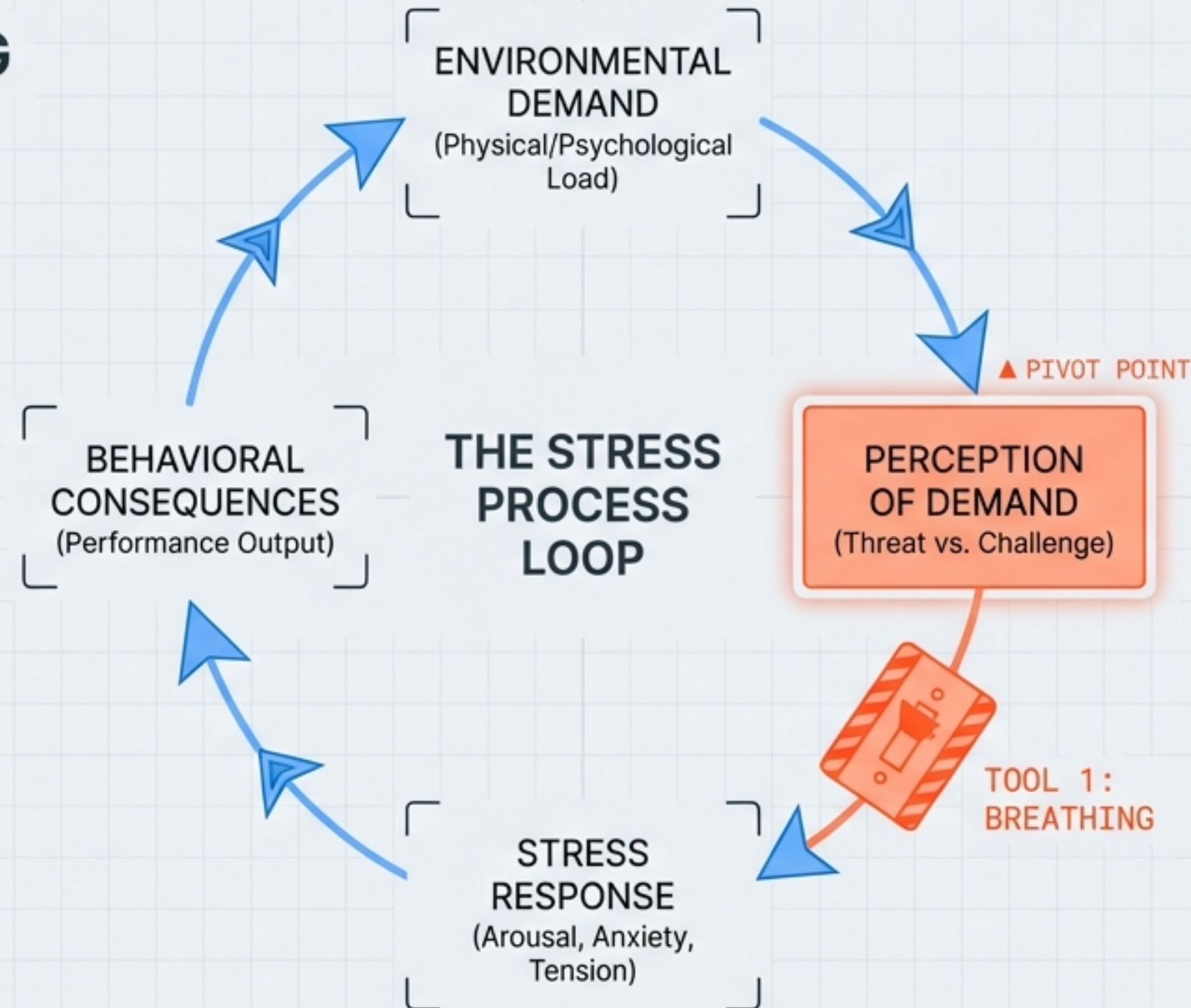


TOOL 1: BREATHING (THE STRESS LOOP RESET)

Breathing is the only physiological function under both voluntary and autonomic control. It serves as a manual override switch.

WARNING:

Unchecked loop acceleration leads to performance crash (Catastrophe Model).



THE FIX (CENTERING)

- ACTION: Deep, rhythmic diaphragmatic breathing.
- RESULT: Sends direct "safety" signal to the brain. Intercepts stress response. Anchors operator in the present.

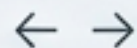
TOOL 2: ACTIVATION/RELAXATION (AROUSAL TUNING)

RELAXATION

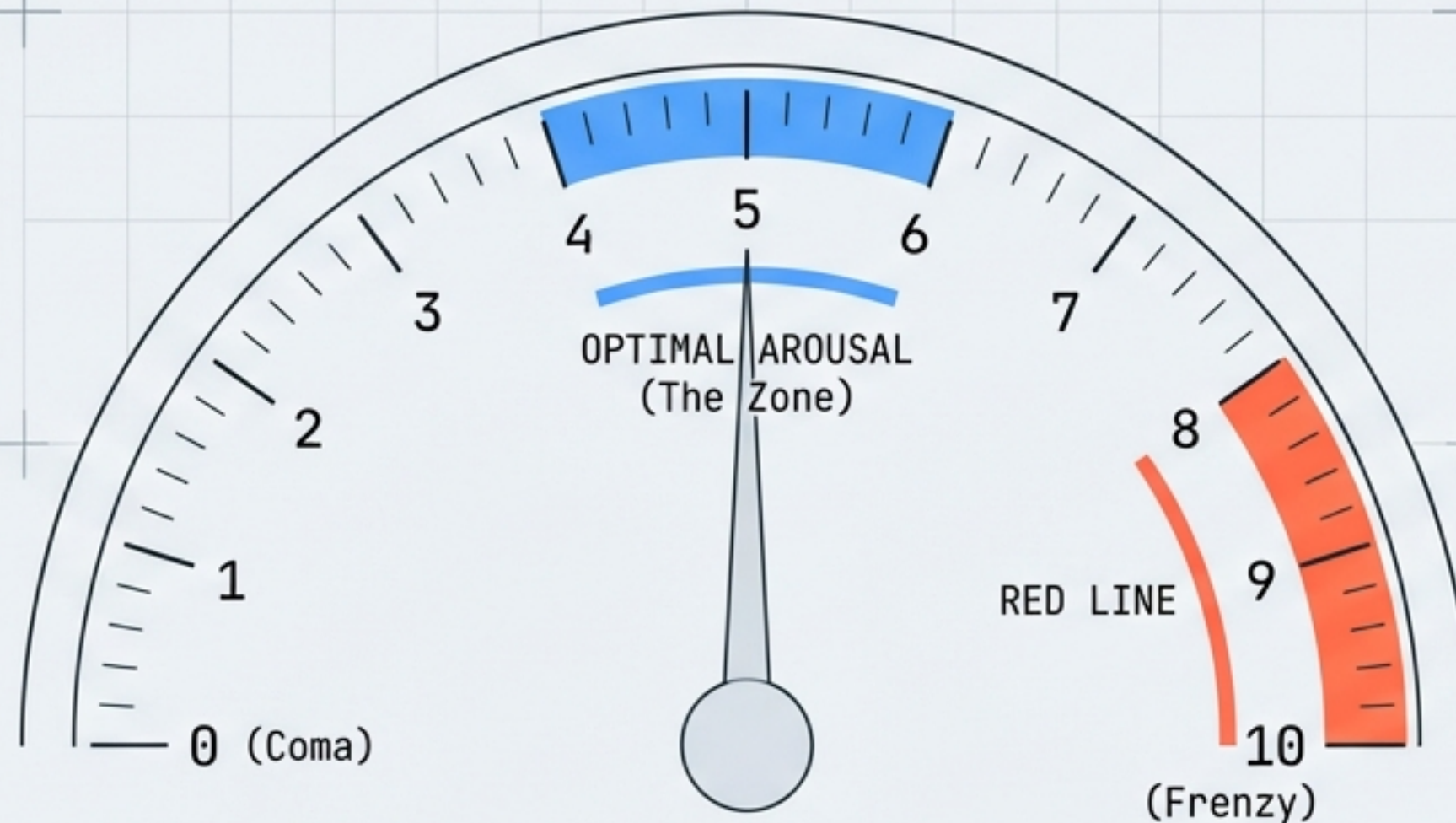
GOAL: RELAXATION

TECHNIQUE:
Progressive Muscle
Relaxation (PMR)

METHOD:
Systematically tense
and release muscle
groups to discharge
somatic tension.



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ACTIVATION

GOAL: ACTIVATION

TECHNIQUE:
Physical Stimulation

METHOD:
High-tempo music,
jumping, slapping legs,
"psyching up" to wake
the nervous system.



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Based on the Inverted-U Hypothesis:
Performance peaks at moderate arousal.

TOOL 3: CUE WORDS (THE FOCUS FILTER)

FAULT: ATTENTIONAL NARROWING



LOCKED: OPTIMAL FOCUS



TARGET ACQUIRED: OPTIMAL FOCUS

DECODER KEYS

INSTRUCTIONAL CUES

Purpose: Fix mechanics/technique.

Examples: "Elbows in", "Smooth", "Follow through".

Use when: Execution is sloppy.

MOTIVATIONAL CUES

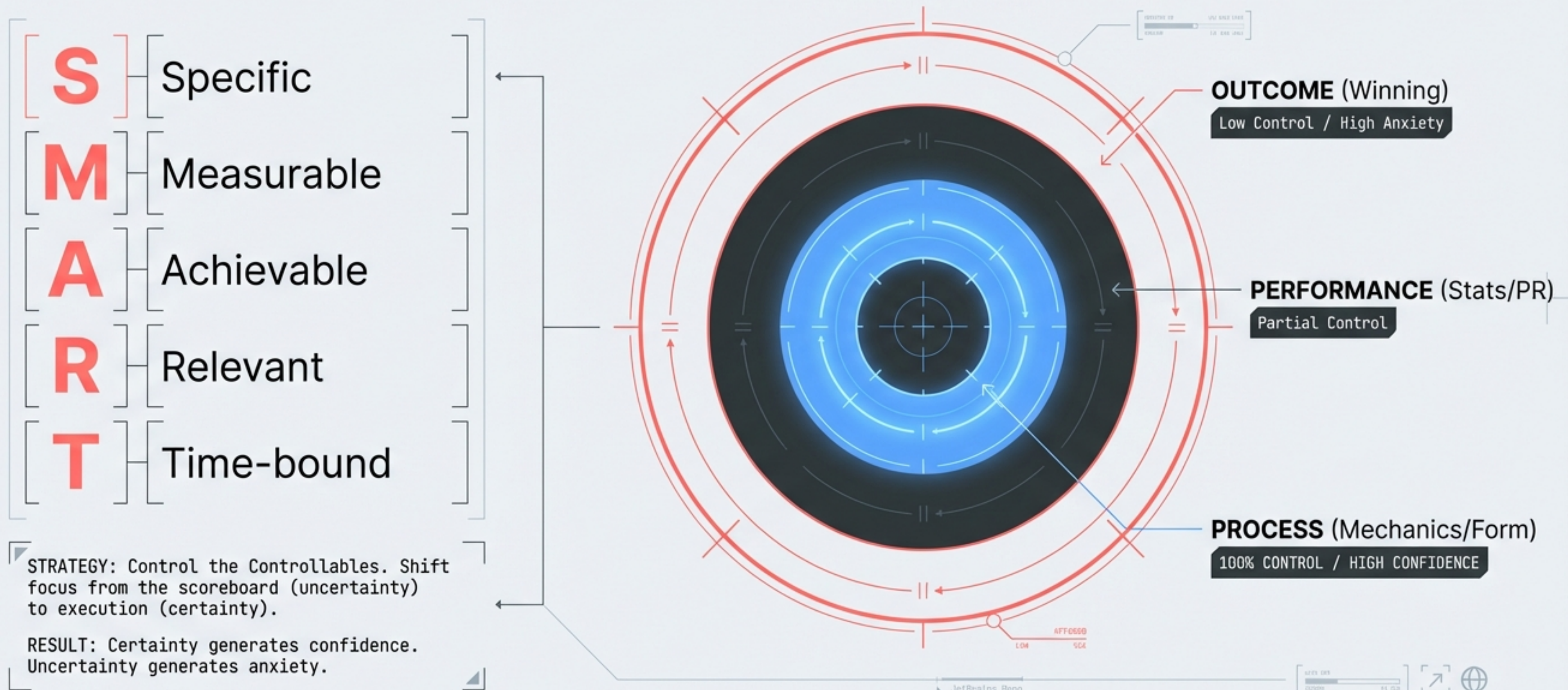
Purpose: Fix intensity/effort.

Examples: "Power", "Dig deep", "Explode".

Use when: Energy or drive is fading.

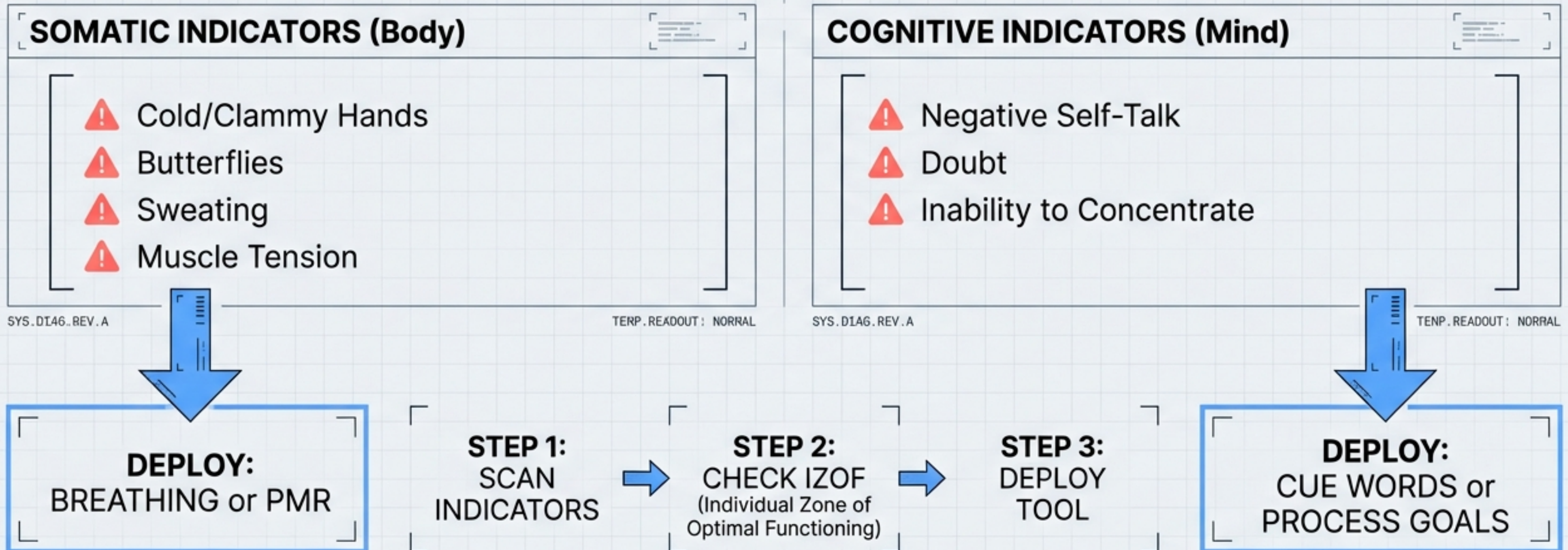
DIAGNOSTIC: High pressure jams the radar. Cue words force the system to lock onto the correct target.

TOOL 4: SMART GOAL SETTING (THE CONFIDENCE BUILDER)



SUMMARY: READING THE DASHBOARD

Recognition is the Trigger for Regulation.



The elite athlete is not without stress; they are simply faster at recognizing and regulating it.